Kissing You

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/36383257.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Kissing You

by Peter_Pandemonium

Summary

It's Halloween and the Best Friend Squad is getting ready for the big, annual party at Mermista's house.
They're also excited to finally meet their friend Perfuma's new girlfriend.

The Super Pal Trio is also attending the party so Scorpia can introduce her besties to her girlfriend Perfuma and a few of Perfuma's friends.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

This is Halloween

Kissing You

This is Halloween

“For the last time, no hair poof!”

“And no ponytail!”

Her roommates' voices came from opposite ends of the apartment, forming a stereo effect of admonishment.

She sighed and fussed with her hair again, before ignoring it and moving on to her costume.
The simple white dress was so unlike her usual style that she frowned slightly as she looked at it.

Then she moved on to the main piece of the costume, the angel wings.
Bow had carefully crafted them for her, and Glimmer had found a way to add an attachment to the dress where they could cleverly be clipped on, leaving a seamless appearance.

She had tried on the whole ensemble last night so her fashion major roommates would have time to make their inevitable final adjustments.
It was going to fit perfectly, that wasn’t the issue.

Since she was fairly hopeless with both hair and makeup, she collapsed on her bed to wait for her friends to finish with their costumes.

Glimmer swept into her room several minutes later and found her sprawled there, still in a t-shirt and sweatpants.

“Adora! Get up! We have to get you ready so we can be fashionably late instead of just actually late!”

A surprisingly short time later, thanks to Bow and Glimmer's combined efforts, she was ready and standing in front of a full-length mirror. She shifted slightly from side to side, watching her reflection with awe. Her roommates flanked her, also watching her reflection with expressions of pride.

"We really outdid ourselves this time, Bow," Glimmer said in an unusually hushed tone.

"You look beautiful Adora."

"I…I don't look like myself."

"It's okay to look pretty sometimes," Bow replied gently.

After another moment of gazing at Adora, Glimmer stepped away and picked up the last piece of her own costume.

"Let me just get my wig on, and then we can take some group pictures and head out!"

She struggled for a moment with the blonde wig, and then leaned forward towards the mirror to adjust it.

"There! Casey Becker is in the house! Bow, get your sunglasses!"

They assembled in the living room to take a series of selfies and then Glimmer carefully removed Adora's wings to keep them safe on the Uber ride over to Mermista's house.

"Guys, I think this is our best set of costumes so far!" Bow said enthusiastically as they waited in front of their apartment building.

Ever since high school, their Halloween tradition was to pick a year and then dress up as characters from movies released in that year.
This Halloween, they'd picked 1996.

A horror movie buff, Glimmer had picked the movie Scream, so in addition to the blonde wig, she was wearing a white sweater

liberally coated with fake blood and carrying an era appropriate cordless phone she'd found at a thrift store.

Bow had gone with Independence Day and was sporting a replica flight suit he'd spent several days sewing, along with sunglasses, dog tags, and a fake Will Smith style mustache.

Adora hadn't been sure what character to dress up as, though she knew she wanted to do Romeo + Juliet as it was one of her favorite movies.
At first, she was leaning towards Romeo, but wasn't quite ready to take the plunge and cut off her hair to really sell it.
When Bow had floated the idea that he could construct the wings, and Glimmer offered to make the dress, that had settled things.

So now, here she was, feeling a bit like a princess.
It was an unfamiliar feeling, but she kind of liked it. She wasn't quite ready to admit that to her friends though.

Their Uber pulled up and they got in the car carefully, not wanting to jostle their costumes.

"Best Friend Squad Halloween 1996 style!" Bow shouted and they all cheered together.

Glimmer stealthily pulled out a flask and passed it to Adora.

As the whiskey burned a path down to her stomach, she settled somewhat.
This was just another party at Mermista's, a place she'd been to countless times.
The Halloween parties were usually the biggest party of the year, but that was fine. It just meant more people she could blend in with.

Even though her wings would make it harder than usual to wedge herself into a hidden corner and people watch…
And her makeup and hair made her look softer and therefore more approachable than either of her two friends…

And they might just want to dance with each other all night leaving her on the sidelines…

She snatched the flask back from Glimmer and took another long swallow.

"Why did I agree to this again?" she grumbled, re-adjusting the shirt yet another time.

"Because Scorpia asked you a total of 37 times and you ultimately relented," was Entrapta's almost automatic response.

"Because you're a good friend and you want me to be happy!" was Scorpia's louder and more excited reply as her large form filled the doorway.

Catra turned and glared at her, but Scorpia gave her such intense puppy dog eyes that she could feel her scowl melting away despite her best efforts.

"Fine, I do, okay! I just don't know why I have to go to this party to prove it."

"This is going to be the first time I meet some of Perfuma's friends and I'm nervous. I need rest of the Super Pal Trio with me as back up!"

Catra waved a hand at Entrapta, who was playing a game on her phone, then gestured at herself before giving Scorpia a pointed look.

"Are you sure you wouldn't make a better impression on Perfuma's dorky friends *without* us there?"

Scorpia looked shocked.
"Of course not! You're my BFFs! Besides, I'm sure Perfuma's

friends are very nice."

"You said this party is at Mermista's house, right? I wouldn't describe her as *nice* exactly. Hot, definitely," she finished with a smirk.

"Well Perfuma said that some of her other friends will be there too."

Entrapta abruptly rejoined the conversation.
"That most likely refers to her three friends who call themselves "The Best Friend Squad". My research indicates that besides Mermista, those are the friends she spends the most social time with. I have them categorized as Tier A."

"Research?!"
Scorpia looked shocked again.

"How many tiers of friends have you categorized?" Catra asked, amused.

"Well, so far I have three distinct tiers, though I need more observation time to determine if four tiers are more appropriate… there is some gray area with classmates vs. true friends…".

"Time out!" Scorpia interrupted, as she made an elaborate time out gesture with her hands.

It was the phrase they used to pause Entrapta when she was getting carried away. As usual, she respected it and abruptly stopped speaking.

"Why are you "observing" Perfuma?"

Entrapta's brow furrowed and she looked at both her friends.
"I always compile dossiers on your romantic partners. It's good to have data available so I can provide appropriate advice…or warnings."

At this, both she and Scorpia stared at Catra meaningfully.

She crossed her arms and said in a slightly offended tone, "I may not have the greatest track record when it comes to dating…"

"I would rate it as two stars out of 5."

"But…"

Now Scorpia cut in.
"Oooo…remember Dee? And how they pretended to be two different people to really mess with your head?"

"That was a very interesting relationship to observe. I compiled several binders of notes…"

"Okay! Enough! If we're actually going to this party, we should finish getting ready."

"Affirmative!"

"Sure thing Wildcat!"

Entrapta bounced away into her room and started rummaging around. Scorpia started buttoning the hideously patterned shirt she was wearing. Catra headed to the bathroom to try and tame her hair.

By the time she finished, both her friends were waiting. Entrapta was wearing a fairly normal (for her) outfit, but had added a lab coat and safety goggles perched on the top of her head.

"I'm a mad scientist!" she screeched, reaching into one of her bulging pockets and pulling out a small beaker filled with colorful liquid. She lifted it above her head as if about to smash it on the ground but paused when both her roommates hastily started shouting and waving their hands.

"I suppose I can save this for the party."
Twin sighs of relief greeted this statement.

Now Catra looked over at Scorpia.
"You look…let's face it…totally ridiculous. But it will be cute with you and Perfuma together."

Her friend preened as much as she could while wearing so much polyester. Her maroon bell bottoms and somewhat matching wildly patterned shirt definitely made a statement.

Scorpia swept Catra up into a crushing hug and then quickly released her, exclaiming, "Oh! I need to help you with your armor!"

"Yeah, thanks," Catra choked out, trying to get her breath back.

She was already wearing her long sleeved fake mail shirt, and Scorpia helped her attach the armor pieces.
Since it was made of actual metal, she'd kept to just the shoulder and arm pieces, forgoing a chest or back plate.

Once it was fastened on, she made some experimental movements to test how restricted her movement would be.
"You did a great job on this 'Scorp. I can actually move my arms."

Her roommate was studying history and had become fascinated with historical arms and armor.
When Catra brought up Joan of Arc as a costume idea, Scorpia had jumped on the chance to make her something by hand.

Catra picked up her replica sword and swung it around a few times.

"Yeah, this is so much better than some cheap plastic shit."

"Thank you! It was so much fun! I might even participate in the Renaissance Faire this year!"

Somehow, she turned a sarcastic comment into a neutral one, even though she thought of the Ren Faire crowd as pretty high up on the loser pyramid.
"That's great Scorpia. So, are we ready?"

“I just want to take a couple pictures first!”

A couple pictures turned into what felt like a hundred, but Catra stayed mostly patient as Scorpia directed them into various poses.

Right before Catra was about to snap, Scorpia mercifully decided she’d “captured enough memories for the moment” and started to usher them towards the door.

Catra sheathed the sword and made sure her keys and phone were tucked into the pockets of her pants before allowing herself to be pulled outside.

Scorpia had offered to be the designated driver, which Catra had agreed to on the condition that her roommate wouldn’t ditch them in favor of crashing with her girlfriend.
Scorpia had pinky promised more dramatically than necessary saying, “I would never abandon my besties!”

From across the room, Entrapta had chimed in, “Pals before hos!” and then beamed, pleased at her attempt to use slang.

Her two friends decided to let it go, preferring to not get into a detailed discussion about rhyme schemes in wordplay and the cultural meaning of the word “ho”.

“Fine. You can DD. I’ll definitely need to drink to get through this party.”

Now, they were in Scorpia’s reliable sedan, heading for Mermista’s fancy house.

“Super Pal Trio Halloween!!”

Entrapta joined into Scorpia’s shouting, and even Catra gave a few genuine whoops of excitement.

Maybe the party wouldn’t be so bad. She looked like a badass in her costume and there would be free drinks.

Though...Scorpia would probably be glued to Perfuma's side all night.
And Entrapta would no doubt wander off to "observe the interesting social interactions".
Plus, she'd have to be nice to Perfuma's dumb friends.

She rolled her eyes. Whatever. She'd get through this.

The epic double staircase was the first thing that caught your eye when you walked in the front door. Adora remembered some awkward senior prom photos featuring that staircase in the background.

She hadn't had a prom date, and had recently realized she was gay but hadn't told her friends yet.
Bow had gone with Perfuma (as friends) which sent Glimmer into a jealous spiral that lasted all evening.
And Mermista had shown up with Sea Hawk but still refused to call him anything but "that guy" and "just my ride".

Thankfully, by the end of the night they were all dancing together in one big laughing, sweaty group.
And thanks to Glimmer's secret whiskey flask and a wild sugar high from a giant stack of syrup laden post-prom pancakes, Adora had come out to her friends.
They were all extremely supportive, and it had turned into one big coming out diner cry-fest as every single person admitted that they were queer.

Adora smiled at the memory as she, Bow, and Glimmer all took in the crowded, lavishly decorated space.

Mermista loved Halloween, but not "tacky shit", and since her parents had let her host a party every year for close to a decade, she'd accumulated quite an impressive array of thematic and somehow classy decorations.

Orange and black bunting was draped artistically along the staircase railings, and soft lighting came from a variety of carefully placed pumpkin lanterns. The music was loud enough to cover the hum of conversation, but not so loud as to deafen the guests. Speakers were subtly hidden throughout the house in cauldrons, giant spiders, and skulls.

“This is awesome!” Bow shouted.

Glimmer squeezed his arm enthusiastically.
“Should we go get drinks?”

Adora nodded and they started for the kitchen when they were intercepted by Mermista and Perfuma.

“Hi friends!”

“Hey.”

“Oh wow, you look great Perfuma. The dress is really working for you.”

Perfuma smiled sweetly and ran her hands down the sides of her extremely loud 70s style dress.
“Me and my honey are doing themed costumes! Once she and her friends get here, I’ll introduce everyone.”

“You better. I want to see who this mystery woman is that you’re so hung up on,” Mermista teased in a dry tone.

“You look pretty badass too,” Glimmer informed her.

“What? This old thing?”
Mermista smirked and did a slow pirouette, letting them take in her elaborate pirate captain costume. It had strong Captain Hook vibes, but was various shades of blue instead of red.

“Wait, what did Sea Hawk dress up as?” Adora asked.

“Oh my god,” Glimmer said, her eyes catching something across the room and widening like saucers.

“Is he…is he…” Bow stuttered.

“A fucking parrot?” Adora squeaked.

Mermista crossed her arms and snickered.
“Yep. It’s perfect right? Always squawking and getting up in my space.”

The Best Friend Squad just stared, dumbfounded until Sea Hawk and his feathers disappeared from view.
Perfuma was still giggling as she and Mermista walked off to greet some other guests.

There was a long moment of silence which Glimmer finally broke.

“Damn. I really need a drink after seeing that.”

They made their way carefully through the crowd and towards the kitchen, pointing out especially impressive decorations as they went.

Once they all had a plastic cup of their favorite libation in hand, Adora asked, “Have either of you met Perfuma’s new girlfriend yet?”

Both her friends shook their heads.

“Perfuma said she’s bringing a couple of her friends along too, but I’m not sure who they are either.”

Glimmer was about to respond when she was interrupted by a scrawny blond kid dressed as a skeleton and brandishing a phone.

“Um, hi. Would it be okay if I took your picture? Like, leaning against the counter and pretending to be on your phone?”

He was staring at Glimmer and then glanced over his shoulder at a woman lingering in the doorway. She gave him a thumbs up and he turned back, smiling nervously.

"Oh…yeah, sure."
Glimmer leaned forward, elbows on the counter and prop phone against her ear.

"Oh, you should do a picture of like, when she's scared and screaming too," Bow said excitedly.

His girlfriend complied, going through a variety of poses to approximate some of Casey's Becker's moments on film.

Finally, they were finished, and the kid thanked them profusely and ducked away.

The woman in the doorway nodded to Adora who waved in response. Then she drifted off into the next room with the boy following along behind her.

"Looks like your costume is a hit," Adora told her friend who grinned in response.

"I told you, it's iconic."
She took a step towards her friend and lowered her voice. "Speaking of costumes being hits…I've already seen a few people checking you out."

Bow had also drifted closer, interested to hear what Glimmer was intriguing about. He gave Adora a thumbs up and then gasped. "Oh! Glim, we should find Adora someone tonight. Her own Romeo! Or, like, lady Romeo. Romea? No, that sounds weird."

"That's a great idea! Adora, if you see anyone you think is hot, let us know. We can totally wingperson you tonight."

"Um…I don't know. I'm not sure a costume party is the best place to connect with someone."

“No, it’s perfect,” Glimmer said emphatically. “You can be whoever you want to be tonight. You literally have wings! You can do anything.”

As her two friends stared at her with almost creepy intensity, Adora backed slowly away under the guise of getting some snacks.
Hopefully they would tone things down, because historically them “helping” her with her love life had chaotic results.

They walked into the entryway and stood gazing at the large double staircase. Catra wasn’t sure what she’d been expecting, but it wasn’t anything this classy. Her experience with college parties was that they were dark, crowded, and packed with obnoxious drunks.

“Nice place, right?” Scorpia asked, gesturing them farther inside the space.

“Yeah, actually.”

Entrapta had already wandered off a few steps to take a closer look at an electronic skeleton that was slowly moving its arms up and down to offer a bowl of candy.

“Fascinating. I think I could improve on its mobility if I…”

Suddenly, Scorpia’s polyester clad frame slid in front of the decoration.
“Please don’t break anything. I really want to make a good impression on Perfuma’s friends.”

Entrapta looked at Scorpia’s earnest face and then over to Catra who nodded.

“Okay! I will do my best to not intentionally damage anything!”

Her larger friend sighed and cautiously backed away.
“Thank you. I’m going to look for Perfuma and then I’ll meet back up with you, okay?”

“Fine," Catra replied. "I’ll go grab a drink or something. And I’ll keep an eye on…and…she’s already gone.”

They both glanced around, but saw no sign of Entrapta.

“How does she do that?” Scorpia asked, scratching her head. “She isn’t exactly inconspicuous.”

“No idea. It’s all good. Go find your girlfriend.”

Her friend smiled and walked away, jostling a zombie and a ghost she tried to squeeze through the crowd.
“Oh gosh…I am so sorry…pardon me…”

As Scorpia’s voice trailed away, Catra allowed herself one long moment to scowl, and then squared her shoulders and plastered on a more neutral expression.

She didn’t love being left alone in a crowd of strangers, but she really did want to support her best friend.
With a sigh, she started moving away from the front door, hoping to find wherever the free drinks Scorpia had promised were located.

Eventually, she found herself in the kitchen which was filled with multitude of drink options. She fished a beer out of a giant pumpkin shaped cooler, and glanced around, hoping to catch a glimpse of either Scorpia or some kind of alcove she could tuck herself into.

Unfortunately, she found neither, just a bunch of costumed strangers talking, bouncing to the music, or grabbing drinks and snacks. Continuing through the kitchen, she found herself in another larger space that seemed to be the dance floor. The music was a little louder here, and the lights were dimmer. This wasn’t

where she wanted to be either. With a sigh, she crossed into the next room.

Thankfully, this one was quieter and less populated. She found Entrapta in an intense conversation with one of her computer science classmates, and decided not to bother her.
As she passed by, her friend waved vigorously, and then turned back to her conversation.

Finally, Catra found an unobtrusive place to stand where she had a decent bubble of personal space, but didn't look like a weirdo staring at people from an awkward distance.

She'd just taken a long swallow of her beer when an excited voice behind her asked, "Is that a real sword?!"

Sword Lesbians and Gay Panic

Chapter Summary

Catra meets a beautiful stranger.

Adora tries to have some chill.

The Super Pal Trio and Best Friend Squad meet each other.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Kissing You

Sword Lesbians and Gay Panic

Turning, she saw an unreasonably beautiful girl with a goofy, excited smile on her face.

Once she'd regained the power of speech, she responded, "It is, yeah."

The girl's eyes widened with excitement, and she managed to reach out and run her fingers along the hilt before Catra smacked her hand away.
"Hey, maybe ask before you touch?"

"Sorry, sorry! It's real though. That's badass!"

"Never thought I'd hear an angel say "badass"."

The girl seemed startled, and a faint blush dusted her cheeks.

"What?"

"Your costume?"

"Oh, right."

A few moments of silence passed which the other girl eventually broke.
"I don't usually dress like this. I mean, obviously this is a costume, but…you know…like this."

"She really was beautiful," Catra mused to herself, taking a longer look at the girl before her before she responded.

"I think you look really pretty," she finally said.

The other girl's blush deepened.
"Thanks. I'm not used to being pretty. My usual vibe is more, um, sporty I guess."

"I bet you make that vibe look cute too." She extended a hand. "I'm Catra by the way."

The girl's grip was firm and her hand was warm.

"Adora. It's really nice to meet you."

"Would you like to go and get a drink with me, Adora?"

She pointed her empty bottle in the direction of the kitchen.

Adora seemed startled but pleased.
"Sure, as long as you help clear a path for me. I don't want to get my wings smashed."

Catra dipped into a bow.
"At your service my angel princess."

Then, impressed by her own boldness, she gently wrapped a hand around Adora's wrist and started leading her through the crowd.

On the inside, Adora was dying of gay panic. A super-hot girl with a sword had called her pretty and was currently practically holding her hand.

Oh my god, what do I do? She has to be gay, right? But how do I find out for sure without sounding like a creep? How do I make sure she knows I'm gay?!

She caught a glimpse of Bow and Glimmer off to the side as she passed. Glimmer took in the situation, and then punched Bow in the arm hard enough that he staggered. The last thing Adora saw before they left her peripheral vision were her two friends gaping at her.

Once they made it to the kitchen, the hot girl *(Catra)* turned to her with a smirk.
"What's your poison?"

"Uhhhhh…."
Adora had a brief internal conflict on whether to try and come up with something classy, or to just tell the truth. She couldn't think of anything else, so she settled for the latter.
"Oh, usually I just drink cheap beer."

Suddenly she was staring into two amazing different colored eyes as Catra took a step closer.

"But what do you *want*?"

The other girl's voice was low and musical, snaring Adora and robbing her of speech for another long moment.

Unable to hold that gaze without doing something stupid like pushing this stranger against a wall and kissing her senseless, Adora cast her eyes wildly across the room. A large steaming crock pot caught her eye.

"Maybe some of that cider?"
She pointed at the large bottle next to it.
"With some of that whiskey."

"Excellent choice princess," Catra purred.

"Decided to drop "angel" from the nickname?"

Adora had a moment to be proud of herself for getting in a teasing statement and then Catra stepped infinitesimally closer .

"Oh, I think princess rolls off the tongue better, don't you?"
Then she winked and turned to walk across the kitchen.
"Be right back."

Who looked that good winking in real life? A hot girl just said the word "tongue" to me. Is she flirting? Oh my god, I have to flirt

back. How does flirting work again?

These and other similar thoughts skittered through Adora's mind until Catra returned, handing her a slightly steaming cup and holding a beer bottle in the other hand.

She took a cautious sip.
"This is really good. Thanks!"

"I went easy on the whiskey. I don't want to be responsible for getting a princess wasted."

"What if I don't want to be responsible?"

Catra's brows shot up and a thin, wicked smile crossed her face. But whatever she was about to say was cut off as someone loudly shouted her name from the kitchen doorway.

"Sorry princess. I have to go see what my friend needs. But I hope to see you later."

Adora watched her walk away to join a girl in a lab coat who seemed to be bouncing up and down with excitement. Or maybe she'd been binging on Halloween candy.

Disappointed, Adora drained her cup and went to make herself a refill. She'd just finished adding what she hoped was an appropriate amount of whiskey when she heard Glimmer's voice behind her.

"Adora! There you are!"

"Hey Glimmer. Enjoying the party?"

Her shorter friend nudged her gently in the side.
"The question is, are you? Don't think I didn't see you with that hot girl!"

"Glimmer, I think she was flirting with me."

“I bet she was! You look beautiful. Were you flirting back? Tell me you flirted back!”

After clocking Adora’s sheepish expression, Glimmer scowled.

“Adora!”

“I know, I know. She’s just…like…super hot. And confident.”

Her friend crossed her arms.

“So?”

“And you know I have no game. And…,” she gestured to herself, “this isn’t how I usually look at all. What if she’s only into all this… femme-ness?”

“First off, you do have game…sometimes…kind of…”

Adora groaned.
“That really raised my confidence, thanks.”

But now her friend looked like she had an idea. Unfortunately, Glimmer’s ideas often led to disaster or embarrassment, but before she could shut her down, her friend was off.

“You said you aren’t yourself tonight, right? So don’t be yourself. Be a confident, sparkly angel version of yourself.”

The chances that she, a person who was terrible at lying and fell into a gay panic when a hot girl talked to her, could pull off acting the role of a confident, charming angel seemed slim.
But in her head she saw beautiful mismatched eyes and perfect, smirking lips and decided that it was worth a shot.
“Okay, why not. I’ll at least try.”

Glimmer threw a fist in the air.
“Yes!”

Then they both noticed Bow motioning at them from the next room.

"Oh, I bet it's time to meet Perfuma's new girlfriend. C'mon, I'm so curious!"

Catra threw a swift glance over her shoulder as she walked away. It definitely hadn't been her plan to meet someone tonight, but a beautiful dork with pretty blue eyes who was into swords? She definitely wanted to talk to Adora some more.

When she got to Entrapta, her friend was bouncing up and down on her toes.

"What's up?"

"Scorpia wanted me to find you! It's time to meet her girlfriend!"

"Okay, inside voice please."

"Sorry! I mean, sorry. There are a lot of miniature candy bars here…and I may have consumed many of them."

"It's all good. Lead the way."

They ended up at the front of the house in a small side room.

Scorpia and Perfuma were standing at the center in all their psychedelic polyester glory.
Next to Perfuma was a curvy, long-haired girl dressed as an impressive pirate captain.

"Hey Merms," Catra said as she and Entrapta crossed the room to stand at Scorpia's other side.

"Damn. Catra at a costume party? Never thought I'd see that. You look great though."

She flashed Mermista a gleaming smile.
"So do you. And I heard your parties were worth coming to."

"You heard right."

Scorpia now drew their attention as she proudly introduced Perfuma.

"These are my besties, Catra and Entrapta. This is my girlfriend Perfuma."

The tall, slender woman gave them a warm smile and shook each of their hands gently.

"It's so nice to finally meet you. Scorpia has told me so much about you! What an honor to have the Super Pal Trio all in one place."

"Isn't she the best?!" Scorpia gushed, staring at her girlfriend with a goopy look on her face.

"It's very nice to meet you too," Catra replied in her most polite tone.

"It is indeed! So far the data shows that…"
Entrapta abruptly stopped talking as Catra elbowed her in the side.
"Yes, nice to meet you!" she continued in a bright tone.

Thankfully, Perfuma seemed unfazed.
"I also wanted you to meet some of my best friends. They should be heading over now."
She waved at someone coming into the room.
"And here they are!"

Catra looked up to see a tall man in a flight suit, a shorter woman in a blonde wig and a bloody sweater, and…*Adora.*

The first two looked at her curiously, then darted excited looks between her and Adora that she stopped paying attention to the

moment she was captured by big blue eyes.

“Hey Adora,” she said, just loud enough for the blonde to hear it.

Instantly, the other girl was flustered.
Before she could reply though, Perfuma’s warm voice cut in.

“Oh good! Everyone’s here. Now we can make proper introductions.”

The eight of them were now standing in a roughly circular formation. Looking around at the assembly, Perfuma clapped her hands together joyfully.
“Okay, let’s do an icebreaker.”

A combination of enthusiastic and unenthusiastic noises responded.

“Don’t worry, I’ll make this a simple one. Just say your name, what your costume is, and why you chose it.”

Everyone looked at everyone else for a moment, and then Scorpia said in an excited tone, “I can go first! Ok, hi, I’m Scorpia and it’s really great being here and meeting you all. And tonight I’m going for a 70s vibe and doing this couples costume with my sweetie.”

“Thanks honey, that was great. I’m Perfuma, the other half of this flower power couple.”

She and Scorpia laughed more than necessary at that joke, and then Perfuma gestured at the tall man to go next.

“Hi everyone, I’m Bow. Me and the rest of The Best Friend Squad always do movie themed costumes, and this year we’re doing movies from 1996! So I’m Captain Steven Hiller from Independence Day as played by Will Smith.

“Your costume looks great, Bow,” Scorpia told him excitedly.

"Thanks, I sewed it myself! Glimmer and I are fashion majors, so we like to try and make our costumes instead of buying them. We made Adora's too!"

Everyone turned to look at Adora giving Catra another opportunity to check the girl out.
Even though her look was soft, the sleeveless dress was showing off a lot of lean muscle.
Catra wouldn't mind getting to experience that contrast of strong and beautiful from a much closer vantage point.

She must have zoned out while the short girl was talking about her costume, because suddenly Entrapta was nudging her.

"Catra, it's your turn to discuss your attire."

A quick glance around showed that everyone was now looking at her. Great.

"I'm Catra. One third of the Super Pal Trio."
She felt an embarrassed twinge as she said those words, but seeing the way Scorpia lit up when she heard them, was almost worth it.
"Anyway, my costume is Joan of Arc. Scorpia helped with the armor. And before anyone else asks, yes, the sword is real."

As if to prove her point, she unsheathed it and held it aloft, letting the light reflect off the edge.
Before settling it back in the sheath, she gave Adora a wink.

She watched several expressions chase their way across the blonde girl's face before she took a visible deep breath and spoke.
"I'm Adora, the final Best Friend Squad member. And I dressed up like Juliet from Romeo + Juliet, which is one of my favorite movies. I was thinking about doing Romeo at first, but I wasn't sold on cutting my hair, and then Glimmer and Bow offered to help me with the dress and the wings so…"
Seeming to realize she was starting to ramble, she abruptly stopped speaking.

“They did a really great job!” Scorpia burst out. “Those wings are perfect!”

“You look really beautiful Adora,” Perfuma added in a gentler tone.

Catra had been briefly imagining Adora with short hair…maybe including an undercut, but not wanting to get caught zoning out again, shook off those images and nudged Entrapta.

In a loud, flat tone, her friend said, “I’m Entrapta and I’m a mad scientist.”

“Is that your costume or just, like, who you are?” Mermista asked in an amused drawl.

“Both!”

“Oh, yeah, I'm here too,” their party host then continued. “I’m Mermista and I dressed up like a pirate captain. I just thought it would be cool. Maybe I was inspired by Anne Bonny, but you know, don't make a big thing out of it.”

After a moment of them all blinking at each other, Perfuma clapped her hands.
“Yay! Thank you so much everyone. That was very enlightening. I hope everyone has a great time tonight and that we’ll all get to see more of each other in the future.”

“Yeah, what Perfuma said,” Scorpia added with a huge smile. She then motioned her friends to come closer.

Out of the corner of her eye, Catra noticed Adora getting pulled away to the other side of the room by her two friends with Mermista drifting after them.

Adora had enough time to take one step towards Catra before Bow and Glimmer had each grabbed one of her arms and started dragging her off into the corner.

“Hey!” she whisper shouted at them, but they didn’t respond until they had her on the far side of the room and had spun her around so her back was to the rest of the group.

Then, they ignored her, too busy having their own excited conversation in low voices.

“Did you see that flirting? And that wink?”

“She’s really hot, and she has a sword!”

“She was totally gazing at Adora in a gay way, like so gay.”

“Would that be gay-zing then?”

Glimmer and Bow started cracking up at Bow’s bad pun, and before Adora could say….something…a lazy amused voice said from behind her, “So, like, is everyone just going to ignore the fact that their costumes match? Romeo and Juliet party scene?”

Three pairs of eyes flew to her face, over to Catra, and then at Adora’s costume.
Then their mouths all gaped open.

Mermista sighed. “Are you fucking kidding me? Oblivious much?”

Bow and Glimmer’s excitement ratcheted up several more levels and they started babbling to each other in such high-pitched, rapid tones, that Adora could only make out every few words.
It seemed that they must have decided something though, because they both faced Adora with wide creepy smiles and big shiny eyes.

Mermista took that in and immediately took a few steps towards the doorway.
“Yeah, enjoy the party and have fun with…whatever this is. I’m going to check on Sea Hawk.”

Adora was left alone with her two friends and the strong sensation that she should back away slowly.

She settled for raising her hands in what she hoped was a calming manner.
"Listen…whatever weird plan you just came up with, just forget about it."

"But if we forget about it, nothing will happen! And this is clearly fate or something!" was Glimmer's rejoinder.

"If I go talk to her, will you calm down and leave us both alone?"

"Are you actually going to flirt with her, or are you going to be a lesbian disaster?"

Yes! I will flirt with her. Just…have a little confidence, okay?"

Glimmer was still giving her a stubborn look, clearly unconvinced, but Bow laid a gentle hand on her shoulder.

"I think Adora's right. Let's give her some space, okay?"

"Thank you! Now, if you'll excuse me, I'm going to go talk to Catra."

Once she was out of earshot, Glimmer whirled on Bow.
"Bow! Do you really think she can handle this on her own?"

He just smiled and wrapped an arm around her.
"No. That's why we're going to help, but from a distance. Like fairy godmothers."

Catra stood with Entrapta as Scorpia and Perfuma stood beaming at both of them.

"I'm so glad you decided to come after all," Perfuma was saying. "Scorpia said you were a little hesitant."

Catra shot a glare at her friend who shrugged.
"I'm just not a huge fan of crowds. And to be honest, the other

college parties I've been to have had a way different vibe. This one is…alright."

"I am also enjoying the festivities! Especially the tiny candy!"

"Mermista always throws a good party."

In an attempt at a casual tone, Catra asked Perfuma, "So, how long have you known Adora? And, I mean…everyone else too."

Scorpia looked at her, surprised, knowing full well that Catra never asked about random people in casual conversation. Usually, she just had Entrapta investigate them online and would then decide whether or not they were worth talking to.

Thankfully, her friend just furrowed her brow and stayed silent, letting Perfuma answer.

"Oh, I've known Adora and Bow and Glimmer since high school. Why do you ask?"

"No reason! I mean, just making small talk, you know?"

Now Entrapta turned to stare at Catra.
"According to all relevant data, "small talk" is among the top things you wish you could "kill with fire", along with bad coffee, and a group of people known colloquially as "Karens".

Now the center of attention, Catra squirmed and tried to think of a good out that wasn't just speed walking away to hide in the bathroom, when she heard a soft voice behind her say, "Hey."

When she turned, Adora was standing there, biting her lip nervously and looking just as beautiful as before.

"Hi Catra. I was just wondering if you wanted to…"

"Go grab another drink with you? Absolutely!"
Catra grabbed Adora's arm and tugged her off in the direction of the kitchen.

“See you all later!”
The other three were left staring after her.

Perfuma and Scorpia exchanged a look and then Perfuma asked, “Do you think…was she asking that because she’s interested in Adora?”

“Like Entrapta said, Wildcat is usually very anti-small talk. And they did just walk off together.”

“Oh, that would be so cute! Adora hasn’t dated anyone in a while and she’s such a good person.”

“Catra could definitely use a good person to date…for a change.”

Entrapta was still standing by, silent as she typed something into her phone.
After a moment she nodded, and without warning, zipped away.

They were halfway into the next room before Catra dropped Adora’s arm and stopped walking.

“Sorry I cut you off back there. They were all being weird and I needed an out.”

“No problem.”

They stood smiling at each other for a moment before they both seemed to realize they were staring and looked away.

Adora really wanted to say something like, “Your eyes are beautiful.”
But that seemed way too cheesy, so she settled for, “Did you want to get another drink?”

When Catra didn’t immediately respond, Adora’s brief moment of chill abandoned her and she babbled, “It’s totally fine if not. Like if you just needed an out, that's cool. I can leave you alone and…”

The flow of words was cut off as fingertips gently grazed her cheek.

“I’m down to get another drink. But, after that, could we just hang out? Like, talk maybe? I want to know more about you.”

“Oh! Yes!”

Catra smiled and led the way to the kitchen, dodging through the crowd while making sure not to leave Adora behind.

Once they had acquired new drinks, they made their way to a quieter spot. Adora somehow mustered up the courage to speak first.

“So, um, I’m assuming you also go to school at BMU?”

Catra nodded.
“Yep, I’m a senior.”

“Me too! What’s your major?”

“I’m double majoring in women’s studies and literature actually.”

“Oh wow, so you’re smart!”

Catra snickered and Adora blushed.

“I mean, I think so. But mostly I just like to read and argue with people, so it works.”

The blonde gave a crooked smile which Catra found charming.

“I’m studying to become a physical therapist.”

“Oh yeah? Interested in the human body?”

The way that Catra’s voice rasped a little on the last word momentarily flustered Adora, so she took a gulp of her drink before continuing.

"To be honest, I mostly got interested in it because I've gotten injured so many times and physical therapy was so helpful. So, now I can learn to fix myself!"

Her joke seemed to land because the other girl chuckled.

"How did you get injured so much? Were you one of those daredevil kids?"

"Well…more like a combination of clumsy and overly competitive. I have a twin brother and I always wanted to prove I could do anything he could do. Except I wouldn't settle for doing the same thing, it always had to be more extreme. Climb higher…ride my bike off a bigger ramp…lots of things that ended with me on the ground."

"That tracks I guess. What was it like having a twin?"

"Wow, I mean, I love my brother Adam, but we used to fight *a lot*. Now that we aren't teenagers and we don't have to live together, things are a lot better. Do you have any siblings?"

A shadow passed over Catra's face, and she knew that Adora clocked it because the corners of her mouth dipped in a slight frown.

"Only child. And my family situation wasn't great…let's just say that going away to college was a blessing."

Those big blue eyes were now filled with sympathy.
"Do you want to talk about it?"

Catra did not want to talk about it, knowing how much of a mood killer the topic of her past was. But there was something about Adora that made her feel safe, which was wild since they'd just met and she was generally very untrusting of new people.

"Maybe another time?" her voice came out gentle. "It's some heavy stuff. Not really the right vibe for a party."

The responding smile she got was sweet.
"No pressure. But if you ever want to talk about family, or anything really, I'm a good listener. I could even buy you a drink?"

Catra's eyebrow raised, and she smiled.
"That sounds nice…I think."
Now her tone was more teasing.

Internally, Adora was reviewing her words and wondering if she'd asked Catra on an extremely depressing date…or if she was accidentally implying that she wanted to be friends.
Good listener? Talking about family trauma? That wasn't sexy at all.

Thankfully, Catra's voice broke in before she could really spiral.

"Are we going to talk about the elephant in the room?"

Still somewhat caught up in her thoughts, Adora could only respond, "Huh?"

"Our matching costumes?"

"Oh, yeah…I didn't want to say anything before, because I know it wasn't on purpose…and I wasn't sure if you'd ever seen the movie…" she trailed off, and then continued with bubbling enthusiasm, "but you look so much like Romeo in his knight costume! It's so good! We've got to take some pictures at some point. Maybe some with your sword!"

A joyful, lilting laugh punctuated by a squeak burst out of Catra.

It was the cutest thing Adora had ever heard in her life.

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading! 💖

I plan to post the final chapter within the next couple weeks.

Fairy Godmothers and Wingwomen

Chapter Summary

Bow and Glimmer team up with Entrapta to help the romance along.

Not that Catra and Adora actually need their help...

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Kissing You

Fairy Godmothers and Wingwomen

Bow and Glimmer had done their best to unobtrusively shadow Catra and Adora, though they stopped short of following them into the kitchen.

Thus, they saw the brief cheek touch, and like a lesbian watching a gay period drama, knew that this signaled the beginning of an epic romance.

Bow nearly melted into a puddle as he wheezed out in a high-pitched voice, "Oh my goddess Glim! Did you see that? The delicate brushing of the fingertips? Everyone knows that a cheek touch is inherently romantic."

Glimmer nodded, seemingly deep in thought, a calculating look on her face.
"So Catra has some game, but will Adora be able to handle it?"

"I have faith in her!" Bow exclaimed, but then they exchanged a look as they both mentally ran through some of Adora's peak lesbian disaster moments.
"But…maybe we should be on stand by. Just in case," he added.

Then a voice right behind them said, loudly, "Are you also working on Operation Catradora?"

They both let out a yelp, and jumped, trying to turn at the same time and bumping into each other awkwardly.

A few people nearby moved further away, looking at them oddly.

Standing behind them was Entrapta, a broad smile on her face, seemingly unruffled by their loud exclamations and stumblings.

“Operation what?” Glimmer finally managed.

“Operation Catradora. A mash-up of their names that I believe is known as a “ship” name. From my observations thus far, there is already a strong level of romantic interest between them that appears to be reciprocal.”

Glimmer and Bow stared at her like she was speaking a foreign language.

Entrapta frowned and tried again in a slow, exaggerated tone.
“Catra and Adora seem to like each other. I would like to help them date. Would you also like to help?”

“Oh! Yes, yes! That’s what we were just talking about,” Bow replied, once the words truly registered.
“But how are we supposed to help?”

Entrapta stuck her phone out at them and pressed play on a video. It was a clip of the Capulet party scene from the Romeo + Juliet movie when the two protagonists met.

“I propose we attempt to re-create the romance of this movie!”

Glimmer and Bow both looked excited. They loved romantic missions.

“Okay, but how?” Glimmer asked, looking around at the party somewhat skeptically.

“We just need to set the right tone! Come with me!”

As she darted off through the crowd, pigtails flying behind her like purple streamers.
Bow and Glimmer exchanged one glance, then shrugged and chased after her.

Catra was pleased that their conversation hadn't been interrupted yet. Knowing her friends, it was only a matter of time, but she was determined to make the most of this moment, however long it lasted.

"So, tell me what you like about the Romeo + Juliet movie. You said it was one of your favorites, right?"

The blonde gave her an almost shy look, like she was trying to decide something, and after a long pause said, "I feel a little silly talking about it, because mostly I like the high romance of it. And when I say that, I mean the love at first sight aspect of it, because even though rationally I don't *really* believe in that, I do like the idea of instant connections. That desire to know someone, deeply, from the moment you first meet. I like the way the movie shows that visually and through using Shakespeare's words. Language that might otherwise feel jarring to a modern audience, but they make it work. That isn't the only romantic part of the movie though."

Adora had been looking away for most of her speech, but now met Catra's eyes and found that they were bright with interest.

"What do you see as the other romantic part?"

"The death."

Catra's eyebrow raised, but before she could say anything, Adora continued, "I don't mean romanticizing the *actual* deaths of Romeo and Juliet, because there's a lot of layers there…it's more… the concept of death and how it brackets life. The way it's inevitable and a part of everyone's story. Maybe that sounds strange."

But Catra wasn't looking at her like she was strange, she was looking at her like she was seeing her for the first time and was intrigued by what she'd found.
Then, in a low voice, she recited, "Because I could not stop for Death – He kindly stopped for me."

A slow smile wound across Adora's face, and she waited to see if Catra would continue, wanting to hear more of her voice. She was not disappointed.

"I like the word choice in that poem, "kindly". As much as we try to hide from and avoid the topic of death, you're right, it's a part of everyone's story. I think what makes it romantic in the context of Romeo and Juliet is the aspect of choice. They choose each other, fleeting though it is, and choose not to be without each other. As romantic as it is to think about destiny and star-crossed lovers, I think that choosing someone, over and over, with intention, is much more romantic."

The rest of the room seemed to fade out, everyone else a bit indistinct, as they each absorbed the moment, Catra's last words settling softly around them.

Adora's eyes flicked down to Catra's lips, and back up, where she was caught again by those eyes. Somehow, they'd moved closer to each other.

They were both just starting to lean in when a loud, "Catra!" came from the doorway. Adora hopped back, startled, and Catra whirled, to glare at Entrapta, who was giving her a wide smile and beckoning her with elaborate swoops of her arm.

She turned back to Adora, and touched her arm lightly.
"I'm so sorry about this. I'll see what she wants and then find you again?"

The blonde just nodded slowly, still in a slight daze.

Catra was bundled off by her friend and Adora stood, feeling a bit forlorn.
She stood there, replaying their near-kiss in her mind until Bow found her a few minutes later.

Getting dragged through the party by her insistent friend was not what Catra wanted to be doing right now. She was thinking about that moment when everything else seemed to still, with Adora's face and her soft, hungry expression the only thing in focus.

But Entrapta was still pulling her along, guiding her into a part of the house that she hadn't yet seen, that also seemed to be free of any other party-goers.

"Where are you taking me?"

The words were barely out of her mouth when Entrapta stopped abruptly and Catra staggered, nearly body-slamming her friend from behind.

"We're here!"

"Where is *here*?"

Her friend gave her a wide smile and looked around the room. "I thought you might like to see this room. It's a library or study I think."

Catra took in the space, which admittedly, was very nice. There were bookshelves and comfortable looking leather armchairs, with low lighting provided by a combination of lamps and a fireplace. There was also a large fish tank at one side of the room with some brightly colored fish swimming delicately through the water.

"Okay, this room is nice, but I'm not sure why you had to choose that moment to drag me away."

"I discovered this room in my earlier explorations and thought it would provide the perfect ambiance."

"Ambiance for what?"

"Let's look at the fish!"

Catra let out a deep sigh, but followed Entrapta to the other side of the fish tank and let her friend point out the various fish to her, while she remarked on their species and native habitat.

As Bow walked into the room, Adora shook her head to pull herself out of the reverie she'd fallen into. She wanted to find Catra and kiss her, but also didn't want to overstep and pull Catra away from her friends.

The smile she flashed Bow was somewhat unenthusiastic, but he didn't seem to notice.
"Oh hi Adora. How's it going?"

He didn't give her a chance to answer before he continued in a tone that sounded a little strained.
"Hey, so I found this cool thing that I wanted to show you."

"What cool thing? Why are you being weird?"

A forced sounding laugh came out of his mouth and he scoffed, "I'm not being weird, you're being weird."

Adora sighed, assuming that he and Glimmer were still on their bullshit about Catra.
Then she realized that if that was the case, he might be leading her to Catra in some misguided wingman move.
Her response was suddenly enthusiastic.
"Okay! Show me this cool thing!"

Bow seemed thrown off by her sudden acquiescence.
"Oh, uh, right! It's this way!"

He led her to another part of the house away from the rest of the crowd and stopped in front of a closed door. As Adora stared at him, he knocked on the door and then stood silently for a moment.

She raised her eyebrows as he continued to not move and was about to step past him to push the door open herself when he finally reached for the doorknob.

As they walked into the room, Adora thought she caught movement from the other side, but Bow distracted her by suddenly stopping and looking back towards the door.

"Oh, uh…I think I hear Glimmer calling me. I'll be right back. Why don't you go look at the fish!"
Then he gave her a light push in the direction of a large fish tank and practically ran out of the room.

"What the hell?" Adora muttered to herself as she stared after him.

She supposed she might as well look at the pretty fish while she waited for him to get back from whatever he was actually doing.

Between Entrapta's non-stop talking about the fish and Catra's own distracted thoughts (*mostly about Adora's eyes and lips), she almost didn't hear a distinct rapping sound.*

"Was that a knock?" she asked her still monologuing friend.

Entrapta stared at her for a moment, and then yanked her away to the corner of the room.

"What are you doing?" she hissed, but Entrapta just smiled at her and responded in a quieter voice than she usually used.

"It will be more enjoyable if you just…what's that phrase? Oh…go with the flow."

"But what flow?"

There was movement in her peripheral vision and she turned, but saw nothing but the swimming fish. She turned back, and once

again, Entrapta had vanished.

With a sigh, she walked back towards the fish tank, intending to leave the room. But as she drew near to it, there was a wavering image on the other side which resolved into a blonde figure in a white dress.

She met Adora's eyes through the water and glass, and then the realization hit her.
The movie scene. Entrapta had dragged her in here to stage the movie scene. She saw the same realization flash across Adora's face a moment later and chuckled at the series of expressions that chased across the other girl's face. Then she stuck out her tongue.

Adora's smile was instant and bright and she couldn't help but smile back. She pressed her face close to the glass and crossed her eyes, hearing soft laughter over the bubbling of the water in the tank.

They kept making faces at each other until they were both reduced to uncontrollable laughter, and finally, Catra stepped around and next to Adora.

The blonde girl looked prettier than ever with a slight flush to her cheeks and a sparkle in her eye.

"So it seems that our friends are now conspiring together, which, I'll be honest, is a pretty frightening thought."

Adora took a step closer and smiled shyly.
"You're not wrong. But, it was cool to sort of re-create a movie scene with you."

"Yeah, it was."

They both stood there smiling at each other for a long moment, and then Adora reached out a hand.

"Would you like to dance with me?"

Catra took it, and tried to ignore the way her heart rate immediately picked up.
"We should get out of here before someone dressed as the nurse comes in and drags you away. There's no telling how far our friends are planning on taking this little scene."

Blue eyes cut over at her and a smirk settled on Adora's face.
"Seems like someone knows the movie pretty well."

"I never said I didn't."
She leaned closer to speak almost directly into Adora's ear, not missing the small shiver that the action caused.
"But I have to admit, I like Moulin Rouge better."

The blonde gave a dramatic gasp as she pulled Catra through the doorway and back towards the party.
"I guess I can still dance with you. Maybe we'll just have to watch both movies together and have a spirited debate about which one is better."

Catra's mind immediately imagined this "spirited debate" as an intense make out session.
"That sounds good," she managed to squeak out.

Thankfully, Adora was too wrapped up in her own excitement at inviting Catra to do something that sounded like a real date to pay much attention to her tone as she accepted the idea.

They made it to the edge of the dance floor without any further interference, and faced each other.

Now Adora looked slightly sheepish.
"Um, this might be a good time to tell you that I can't really dance."

"Don't worry. I think this armor and sword might get in the way of my usual moves. We can make it work."

She reached out and took Adora's hands and pulled her closer, still leaving a decent amount of space.

"There. Now we can pretend we're at a middle school dance."

Adora tried to step in time with the music, very conscious of Catra's hands now resting lightly on her waist. After a quick glance behind her to make sure her wings weren't about to bump someone, she asked, "Did you go to any middle school dances?"

That cute laugh sounded again briefly.
"No, I wasn't much for fitting in back then. Scorpia managed to drag me to a couple dances in high school, but…"

"Let me guess. You leaned against a wall and stared at everyone sullenly."

A light blush dusted Catra's cheekbones.
"Damn. Called out."

Adora leaned in closer to murmur in Catra's ear, "I bet you looked really good doing it though."

The other woman scoffed, but smiled as she looked up and into those blue eyes. They both started to lean in, almost imperceptibly, when Adora was jostled by a stumbling guy behind her and tripped to the side.

A hand on her arm steadied her, and then Catra was stepping forward to glare at the guy who'd bumped into her. He wilted under her look and the threat she delivered about her sword not being for show.

Seeing this interaction, the other partygoers around them stepped back slightly giving them a little breathing room.

"Thank you for defending my honor," Adora pronounced, giving Catra a regal nod.

The glare faded from the other girl's face and she smirked, giving a slight bow.
"Of course, my lady. See, I knew you were a princess."

The next song came on and they took advantage of the increased tempo and added space around them to dance with more enthusiasm. Adora forgot to be self-conscious and moved with the music, watching Catra appreciatively as she swayed along with the beat.

Bow had made it to the area where the audio equipment was set up and was staring at it, puzzled. He didn't have long to consider the different cables before someone bounced up next to him.

"Hi!"

He whirled to see that Entrapta had materialized behind him.

"Oh, hi! I was trying to figure out how to change the music, but this is all beyond me."

Entrapta pushed past him to stare at the electronics.
"It is critical we play the song at exactly the right moment. Otherwise my calculations for the creation of an ultimate romantic moment will be totally thrown off!"

She poked at a few things with no result and was about to start unplugging cables when someone cleared their throat loudly.

"Um, what are you two doing?"

They both turned to see Mermista staring at them, arms crossed.

"I specifically designed this party playlist, so like, don't jack it up."

Since Entrapta's only response was a flat stare, Bow hurried to reply apologetically.

"Sorry, we don't want to mess up your party mix, we're just trying to set up an…"

"Ultimate romantic moment!"

"Yeah, that."

Mermista's posture relaxed and her eyes flicked out over the dance floor briefly.

"Is this about Catra and Adora? Because I don't know if they need help with the romance."

Now, the three of them looked over to where the blonde and brunette were dancing together, visible smiles on their faces. As they watched, Adora leaned in to say something in Catra's ear, getting an even wider smile in response.

"You do have a point," Bow said slowly, but continued as Entrapta poked him in the side, "but we have a whole plan in progress and it would be a shame to skip the best part."

Dark eyes flicked over them speculatively, and then a small smile curled against the corner of Mermista's mouth.

"You want to play that song, don't you?"

Her question was met with two pairs of puppy dog eyes.

"Ugh, fine. It's so basic, but also perfect I guess."

She stepped up next to Bow and reached into a drawer to pull out a tablet.
"Okay, let me just cue up the song, and then we can play it at the right moment."

"Yes!" Entrapta burst out, and turned to Bow. "I'll go get into position and you signal Glimmer!"
She started to bounce away, then paused and told Mermista, "If you can achieve lighting more ideal for romance, that would be appreciated."

With that, she rushed off to position herself near one end of the dance floor.

Mermista tapped her finger on the edge of the tablet.
"Luckily I can control the lights and the music from this. Another reason why my parties are the best."

Bow gave her a relieved smile and then looked for Glimmer, giving her a thumbs up once he'd found her in the crowd and caught her eye.
She winked and pulled out her phone, moving closer to where Catra and Adora were still dancing.
He looked in the other direction and saw Entrapta with her phone out as well, poised and ready.
Next to him, Mermista was tapping on the tablet, and then nodded to herself, seeming satisfied.

"Okay, I'm ready to help with your plan. Once this current song is over, it's showtime."

Bow clasped his hands together in anticipation and waited.

On the dance floor, Adora smiled as Catra did a ridiculous shimmy move.

"You like that princess?"

Adora just shook her head, grinning, and then leaned forward to say, "I know I'm tempting fate…but I'm amazed that our friends have left us alone for this long."

Catra chuckled, still swaying to the music as the song started to fade. Whatever retort she was about to toss back stopped as she realized that the lighting was shifting into a softer glow.

The rest of the people around them were starting to glance about, confused, and then a distinctly not dance party song began to play.

The two women recognized it immediately. I'm Kissing You by Des'ree.

After a beat, Catra extended a hand, and when Adora gently rested her own hand on Catra's palm, she brought it up to her lips and kissed it gently.

"May I have this dance?"

The response was a nod and a shy smile.
Catra pulled her close, gently, and felt a set of strong arms wrap around her waist.

They swayed to the music, barely conscious of the lights dimming further and the nearby partygoers catching onto the moment and spreading out to give them some space.

It was an idyllic moment, floating within their own bubble, gazing into each other's eyes. For a moment, Adora dropped her head forward, resting her cheek against Catra's.

Their eyes closed as they both tried to memorize the moment, then at the sound of a few gasps, they both opened their eyes and looked around.

They saw Entrapta tossing something onto the floor that upon impact, started to send out a gentle fog. It appeared that she'd thrown others as well, because different colors were swirling up from other points around them.

She scampered away, and within moments, they were wreathed in a patch of mist in various pastel shades. The lights caught it and diffused into a hazy, fairy tale glow.

Catra leaned in and said in a low voice.
"I would apologize for my friend, again, but this is actually beautiful."

"You're beautiful."

The compliment was delivered in a reverent tone, and before Catra could talk herself out of it, she leaned in, pausing with her

lips almost to Adora's and waiting. The blonde closed the gap almost immediately.

Their lips met, softly at first, but then with increased pressure. The world fell away and it was just the two of them and their first kiss. They both pulled back regretfully, and Catra rested her forehead against Adora's as they stood, still wrapped in each other's arms and swaying to the music ever so slightly.

As the last notes of the song faded away, the silence around them became more apparent, and they broke apart to look around the room. Everyone was staring at them and then suddenly, the room erupted into whistles and cheers.

Adora blushed deeply, and looked like she might flee, but Catra wrapped an arm around her waist and started waving to the room like a pageant queen.

The cheering intensified for a moment, and then as Mermista got the party playlist going, folks either started dancing again or moved on to whatever they'd been doing before the romantic spectacle had caught their attention.

The two of them took the opportunity to leave the room, fingers laced together, to find a more private spot. They made it into the next room and had only a few moments to stare at each other moonily before they were interrupted by a screeching Entrapta, a grinning Glimmer, and a teary eyed Bow.

All three of them were talking at once, and before Catra and Adora could make much sense of what they were saying, Perfuma and Scorpia also appeared, both with big sappy smiles on their faces.

There were a few minutes of excited chatter and teasing from their friends that Catra took with good grace and a smirk, while Adora was reduced to a blushing mess.

Eventually, everyone let them off the hook and wandered off to dance, mingle, or in Entrapta's case, find more candy.

Breathing a quick sigh of relief, Catra turned her bright eyes to Adora.
"So princess, what do you want to do now?"

"Maybe just have a quiet minute together?"

"I like that idea."

They sat down on a conveniently placed couch, close enough together to entangle their hands once more.

After a few moments of comfortable silence, Adora asked, "Will you go on a date with me?"

Catra pretended to ponder the question very seriously.
"Hmmm…"

Adora gently nudged her with an elbow, getting a laughing look from the brunette.

"Yes, of course I'll go on a date with you. I have one condition though."

"What's that?"

"It has to be just us. No annoying friends."

"I agree to those terms."

They exchanged a grin and then fell into easy conversation, continuing to hold hands the entire time.

A while later, Entrapta stepped through the doorway.

"There you are! Scorpia wished for me to inform you that she's planning to leave shortly, if you would like a ride home."

"I'll be right there. Meet you at the front door."

"Affirmative!"
Then Entrapta bustled out of the room, lab coat flapping behind

her, shedding candy wrappers as she went.

In tandem, they both stood up and then stared at each other for a moment, unsure of how to end the night.

Eventually, Catra leaned in to whisper softly into Adora's ear.
"Good Night, Good night! Parting is such sweet sorrow, that I shall say good night till it be morrow."

Before the blonde could respond, Catra had placed a kiss on her cheek and stepped away, taking one long look before turning to follow Entrapta towards the front door.

Adora touched her cheek lightly and had a moment to smile dreamily to herself before Bow and Glimmer popped into the room like a pair of crazed jack-in-the-boxes.

"Adora!!" Glimmer called, "this was the best party ever!"

"It really was," Bow sniffled, looking like he'd been crying off and on for the last hour (he basically had).
"I've never seen anything so romantic!"

"It was destiny!" Glimmer continued, hopping around like an extra from Riverdance.

"Maybe," Adora agreed, with a small, private smile.
"Did you chug a Red Bull or something?"

"She just ate a lot of candy with Entrapta, to celebrate our success," Bow explained.

"Your success? Everything was going fine with me and Catra before you interrupted us."

"But we wanted to make sure it happened. So we did!"

Bow nodded vigorously to agree with Glimmer's outburst and then looked at his phone.
"Our Uber will be here soon. Let's say goodbye to whoever's left."

They followed Bow's advice and were soon tucked into their Uber and on the way home.
Adora had a feeling she'd have good dreams tonight.

In Scorpia's car, Catra stayed silent, trying to ignore the pointed looks her friend was shooting her. In the backseat, Entrapta was playing with her phone, finally coming down from her extended sugar high.

Eventually, Scorpia could no longer contain herself.
"So…"

Catra crossed her arms.
"So what?"

"You know what! You and Adora! It's a Halloween miracle."

"That isn't a thing."

"This is so great. My honey's friends and my friends…linked through love."

Catra groaned and rested her head against the seat.
"Please don't make this weird."

"Are you going out again? Are you dating now?"

"We are going out on an official date…" she started, and was then interrupted by loud cheering from Scorpia, which Entrapta belatedly joined in on.

After silence descended once again and Catra had expelled a long-suffering sigh, she continued.
"We'll see how things go, okay? Like I said: don't make it weird."

There was absolutely no way that the other two-thirds of the Super Pal Trio could uphold that promise, but they both nodded vigorously anyway.

Catra shrugged and looked out the window, catching her own reflection smiling back at her.

Chapter End Notes

Thank you so much to everyone who read this story and left kudos and comments. 💖

If you haven't already, please check out my other stories!

End Notes

This is a stand-alone story I submitted for the SPOP Creative Flex project.

There were three required tags:
1) Inspired by Music/Song - The story title is a song and that song will also be integrated into the plot.
2) They're idiots your honor - In this case represented by some gay panic (mostly from Adora) and the "help" from their friends.
3) Different social groups...forced to mingle - We have The Best Friend Squad and The Super Pal Trio meeting for the first time.

Thank you to the SPOP creative flex moderators and organizers for the prompt.
It fit really well with a story idea I had but didn't know what to do with.

And...it was a good challenge for me to try and write a shorter one-off story.
Cause apparently that's difficult for me to do. This was originally supposed to be one chapter. 😛

If you like this story, please check out my other works.

Thank you to all the fanfic writers out there keeping me (and everyone else) entertained and inspired.
Some of my favorites (in no particular order) are: petty_labelle, bakeApie, DandyVela, harrowhark, lologoblens, RaptorRed, MxSinshine, SimplyKorra, HerotheHardWay, kienava, and motherofchimeras.
Please keep on writing so I can keep on reading. 😊

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!